

Tredegar Iron Works in Richmond, Virginia, one of the few places capable of providing the Confederacy with heavy ordnance. During the war, the task of trying to make up for this industrial imbalance fell to the Confederacy's ever-resourceful ordnance chief, General Josiah Gorgas. The Union also had twice the density of railroads per square mile; the future Confederate states produced 19 of 470 locomotives manufactured that year. In terms of population, the Union had 20.7 million people, against the Confederacy's population of just over 9.1 million, of whom more than 3.6 million were Black Americans—most of them slaves and holding dubious loyalty to their white masters. In the financial sector, Southern banking before the war had been based not in any major Southern city, such as New Orleans or Richmond, but in New York.



White idyll

German artist Edward Beyer's 1855 view of Salem, the county seat of Roanoke, Virginia, idealizes the prewar South. In fact, 33 percent of the county's population in the early 1850s were enslaved.